

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Abrysvo or Arexvy for the treatment to delay Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV)

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for RSV Vaccination and Prevention

Overview

- **RSV** is a common respiratory virus causing **bronchiolitis and pneumonia**, particularly severe in **infants, older adults**, and those with **underlying health conditions**.
- Immunisation aims to prevent **severe disease**, hospitalisation, and death.

Immunisation Options

1. Long-acting Monoclonal Antibody (*nirsevimab – Beyfortus®*)

- Given as a **single intramuscular dose** to provide **passive immunity** for infants.
- **Not a vaccine**, but acts similarly by offering **seasonal protection**.

2. Maternal RSV Vaccine (*Abrysvo® – bivalent RSVpreF*)

- Approved for **maternal immunisation during pregnancy** to protect newborns via **placental antibody transfer**.
- Typically offered during **32–36 weeks gestation** (autumn–winter programme, varies by season and JCVI advice).

Eligibility (UK Immunisation Programmes)

Infants – *Nirsevimab*

- **All infants** born during RSV season (autumn–winter) or entering their first season.
- **High-risk infants**, including:
 - o Premature babies (<29 weeks)

- o Infants with chronic lung disease, congenital heart disease, or severe immunodeficiency

Pregnant Women – Abrysvo (Maternal RSV Vaccine)

- Offered **seasonally** to women between **32–36 weeks gestation** to protect infants for their first 6 months of life.

Older Adults (Awaiting Wider Rollout)

- JCVI supports potential use in **adults ≥75 years** and **65–74 years with risk factors**, but **routine vaccination not yet implemented** across the UK.

Administration

Product	Dose	Route
Nirsevimab	Single 50 mg or 100 mg dose (age/weight-based)	Intramuscular
Abrysvo (Maternal RSV)	Single dose	Intramuscular

- Can be co-administered with other vaccines (e.g. influenza, COVID-19), depending on current UKHSA advice.

Contraindications

- Known severe allergic reaction to a previous dose or any component.
- Defer in the case of **acute febrile illness** (minor illness is not a contraindication).

Side Effects

- Generally mild:
 - o Local injection site pain or redness
 - o Fever, irritability (in infants)
 - o Fatigue, headache, myalgia (in adults)

Documentation

- Record **product name, batch number, date, route, site of administration**.
- Report any adverse reactions via the **Yellow Card Scheme**.

Effectiveness

- Both products have demonstrated **high efficacy** in preventing RSV-related hospitalisations and severe disease in **infants**.
- Maternal vaccination reduces infant hospitalisation by up to **80%** in the first 3–6 months of life.

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Abrysvo

for vaccination against

Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV)

This vaccine is licensed for those who are 60 years and over
and those who are pregnant.

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Abrysvo is indicated for the active immunisation for the prevention of lower tract respiratory disease caused by respiratory syncytial virus (RSV) This vaccine is licensed for those who are 60 years and over and those who are pregnant.
Inclusion criteria	- Adults aged 60 years and over - Pregnant women between 28-36 weeks of gestation - Informed consent obtained - No contraindications to Abrysvo - Where the patient requires immunisation but does not qualify for a free NHS vaccination - Where the patient qualifies for a free NHS vaccination but prefers to have the vaccine privately
Exclusion criteria	- Previous severe allergic reaction to any components of the RSV vaccine - Acute febrile illness (postpone vaccination until recovered). - Those who have already received a complete dose of an RSV vaccine
Cautions	- Observe for 15 minutes post-vaccination. - Advise patients on possible side effects and when to seek medical attention. - Document batch number and expiry date as per local policy. - Use in accordance with the most current national RSV vaccination guidance. - Anxiety-related reactions, including vasovagal reactions (syncope), hyperventilation or stress-related reactions may occur in association with vaccination as a psychogenic response to the needle injection. It is important that procedures are in place to avoid injury from fainting. - Abrysvo has not been studied in pregnant individuals less than 24 weeks of gestation and should not be used in pregnant individuals less than 28 weeks of gestation. - Advise patients who are immunocompromised that they may have a reduced response to the vaccine. - Administer the vaccine with caution to individuals with any coagulation disorders as there is an increased risk of bleeding following intramuscular administration. A fine needle (23 or 25 gauge) should be used for the immunisation, followed by firm pressure applied to the site without rubbing for at least 2 minutes. The individual/parent/carer should be informed about the risk of haematoma from the injection. Do NOT give the vaccine via the subcutaneous route. - Guillain-Barré syndrome has been reported rarely following vaccination with Abrysvo in individuals 60 years and over. Healthcare professionals should be attentive to signs and symptoms of Guillain-Barré syndrome in all Abrysvo recipients to ensure correct diagnosis, in order to initiate adequate supportive care and treatment, and rule out other causes.

	- Co-administration with other immunisations: • If the vaccine is given at the same time as another vaccine administer at different injection sites, ideally in a different limb. If given in the same limb they should be at least 2.5cm apart. • RSV vaccines can be safely co-administered with shingles vaccines, COVID-19 vaccines and pneumococcal vaccines • Some data indicates that, in older adults, administering Abrysvo at the same time as the seasonal influenza vaccine may reduce the immune response to the RSV vaccine. There is also data that suggests that the response to the influenza A(H3N2) component of seasonal influenza vaccine may be diminished when RSV and seasonal influenza vaccines are co-administered to older adults. It is therefore recommended that RSV vaccine is not routinely scheduled to be given to an older adult at the same appointment or on the same day as an influenza vaccine. But if it is thought that the individual is unlikely to return for a second appointment or immediate protection is necessary, Abrysvo can be administered at the same time as influenza vaccination. • Pregnant women can safely have Abrysvo co-administered with the influenza vaccine and COVID-19 vaccine. There is some data suggesting that co-administration of the RSV vaccine with pertussis-containing vaccines may reduce the response made to the pertussis components. Giving the vaccines separately at the typical scheduled times (around 20 weeks for pertussis and from 28 weeks for RSV) will avoid any potential attenuation of antibody response to the pertussis containing vaccine. If a woman has not received a pertussis containing vaccine by the time she presents for the Abrysvo RSV vaccine, both vaccines can and should be given at the same appointment to provide timely protection against both infections to the infant. • Note - Babies born to women who have had Abrysvo can be safely breastfed.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Abrysvo powder and solvent for solution for injection
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular injection, preferably in the deltoid muscle. • The SmPCs/package inserts should be consulted for preparation steps. • For Abrysvo, Pfizer UK also provides a video of reconstitution steps: pfizerpro.co.uk/medicine/abrysvo/dosing/preparation. • Abrysvo should be administered immediately after reconstitution or

	within 4 hours if stored between 15°C and 30°C. Chemical and physical in-use stability has been demonstrated for 4 hours between 15°C and 30°C. From a microbiological point of view, the product should be used immediately. If not used immediately, in use storage times and conditions prior to use are the responsibility of the user.
Dose and frequency	Single 0.5 mL dose.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per person as a single dose.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	One-time vaccination per current guidance.
Adverse effects	Pain at injection site, fatigue, headache, muscle ache, fever. Rare: hypersensitivity or allergic reactions. Refer to SmPC. Fainting can occur following, or even before, any vaccination especially in adolescents. It is important that procedures are in place to avoid injury from faints.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
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Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	• To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell. • Advise that no vaccination is 100% effective. • Individuals should be reassured that the inactivated vaccine cannot cause RSV infection. • Advise that the vaccine will not protect against other influenza, Covid or respiratory viruses in current circulation especially during the winter season. • Immunosuppressed individuals should be advised that they may not have a full immune response to the vaccine.
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Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the

responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	
15/2/26		31/10/26	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		15/2/26
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		15/2/26

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	15/2/26

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Arexvy

for vaccination against

Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV)

This vaccine is only licensed for those who are 60 years and over

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Arexvy is indicated for active immunisation for the prevention of lower tract respiratory disease caused by respiratory syncytial virus (RSV) for 60 years and over
Inclusion criteria	- Adults aged 60 years and over - Informed consent obtained - No contraindications to Arexvy - Where the patient requires immunisation but does not qualify for a free NHS vaccination - Where the patient qualifies for a free NHS vaccination but prefers to have the vaccine privately
Exclusion criteria	- Previous severe allergic reaction to any components of the RSV vaccine - Acute febrile illness (postpone vaccination until recovered) - Arexvy should not be administered to those who are pregnant or breastfeeding. There is no evidence that the Arexvy vaccine is safe in these groups. - Those who have already received a complete dose of an RSV vaccine
Cautions	- Observe for 15 minutes post-vaccination. - Advise patients on possible side effects and when to seek medical attention. - Document batch number and expiry date as per local policy. - Use in accordance with the most current national RSV vaccination guidance. - Anxiety-related reactions, including vasovagal reactions (syncope), hyperventilation or stress-related reactions may occur in association with vaccination as a psychogenic response to the needle injection. It is important that procedures are in place to avoid injury from fainting. - Advise patients who are immunocompromised that they may have a reduced response to the vaccine. - Administer the vaccine with caution to individuals with any coagulation disorders as there is an increased risk of bleeding following intramuscular administration. - Guillain-Barré syndrome has been reported rarely following vaccination with Arexvy. Healthcare professionals should be attentive to signs and symptoms of Guillain-Barré syndrome in all Arexvy recipients to ensure correct diagnosis, in order to initiate adequate supportive care and treatment, and rule out other causes. - Arexvy may be administered concomitantly with COVID-19 vaccine, pneumococcal conjugate vaccine, herpes zoster vaccine and inactivated seasonal influenza vaccine. If Arexvy is to be given at the same time as another injectable vaccine, the vaccines should always be administered at different injection sites.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Arexvy powder and suspension for suspension for injection
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.
Route/method of administration	• Intramuscular injection, preferably in the deltoid muscle. • The SmPCs/package inserts should be consulted for preparation steps and reconstitution. • For Arexvy, GSKPro also provides the reconstitution steps: gskpro.com/en-xg/products/arexvy/administration/ • Do NOT administer the vaccine intravascularly or intradermally. No data is available on the subcutaneous administer of Arexvy. • After reconstitution the chemical and physical in-use stability has been demonstrated for 4 hours at 2°C - 8°C or at room temperature up to 25 °C. From a microbiological point of view, the product should be used immediately. If not used immediately, in-use storage times and conditions prior to use are the responsibility of the user and should not be longer than 4 hours.
Dose and frequency	Single 0.5 mL dose.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per person as a single dose.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	One-time vaccination per current guidance.
Adverse effects	- Pain at injection site, fatigue, headache, myalgia, arthralgia. Rare: hypersensitivity reactions. Refer to SmPC. - Adrenaline injection 1mg/ml (1:1000) must always be available whenever vaccines are given. Immediate treatment for anaphylaxis should include early administration of intramuscular adrenaline and a call to the emergency services. The healthcare professional delivering the service must be trained to recognise an anaphylactic reaction and be familiar with techniques for resuscitation of a patient with anaphylaxis. - Fainting can occur following, or even before, any vaccination especially in adolescents. It is important that procedures are in place to avoid injury from faints.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
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